# DAVID AZEMOH

**Senior Backend Engineer | Kotlin & PHP**

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## PROFILE

Backend engineer with over 11 years building payment, settlement and financial platforms, now focused on Kotlin and PHP. Designs and runs Kotlin services on Spring Boot and Ktor, using coroutines for high throughput I/O, and builds PHP 8 and Laravel APIs for product and back office systems. Background spans fintech, agritech and public sector platforms, including services handling 500,000+ monthly users and cross-border payments across Canada, the United States, India and Africa. Works with PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis and Kafka, deployed on AWS and GCP through Docker, Kubernetes and CI/CD. Also built a Rust LLM serving engine with continuous batching and prefix caching. Focused on transaction integrity, reliability and clean service boundaries.

## KEY COMPETENCIES

- Kotlin, Coroutines & Ktor
- Payments & settlement systems
- PostgreSQL, MySQL & Redis
- Cloud infrastructure (AWS, GCP)
- PHP 8 & Laravel
- REST & GraphQL APIs
- Distributed systems
- JUnit, MockK & PHPUnit
- Java & Spring Boot
- Event driven systems (Kafka)
- Docker, Kubernetes & CI/CD
- Security & ethical hacking

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**ByteX Financial (formerly Cenne Financial) | Canada** **Apr 2026 – Present**

**Senior Software Engineer, ByteX; VP of Engineering, Cenne Financial (Remote)**

- Builds Kotlin and Spring Boot services for ByteX's global payment and settlement infrastructure: cross-border collections, payouts, FX, payment routing and settlement across Canada, the United States, India and Africa.
- Previously led engineering at Cenne, the AI powered financial platform for SMBs in Canada and Africa, covering accounts, cross-border payments, cards and bookkeeping across 150+ countries.
- Carried the Cenne platform through its merger into ByteX, integrating it with ByteX's shared technology, compliance and liquidity foundation.

**Oragonlabs | Nigeria & USA** **Jan 2026 – Mar 2026**

**Chief Engineer & AI Researcher**

- Led engineering and AI research at Oragonlabs, which builds private AI infrastructure that runs on the customer's own hardware.
- Built and published a Python SDK and a Rust serving engine with continuous batching, chunked prefill and a shared prefix cache, handling 200,000 requests in 3.0 seconds, backed by 313 automated tests.
- Designed the licensing layer: Ed25519 signed licences, XChaCha20-Poly1305 sealed model weights that open only in memory, and a hash chained, tamper evident usage ledger, all working fully offline.

**Bullion | USA** **Aug 2025 – Mar 2026**

**Senior Software Engineer & VP of Engineering (Remote)**

- Led development and architecture of high availability financial platform services in Kotlin and Spring Boot, optimised for performance, reliability and transaction integrity in production.
- Improved deployment stability through structured CI/CD and release controls, and implemented monitoring to enhance incident response.
- Provided technical leadership and mentorship, supporting engineers across distributed teams.

**TeflonHub | Lagos, Nigeria** **Aug 2023 – Jul 2025**

**Lead Platform Engineer (Remote)**

- Led design and development of core platform services in PHP (Laravel) and Kotlin across the full software development lifecycle, from technical design through deployment.
- Ensured service stability, availability and scalability, managing releases, upgrades and performance across the platform.
- Mentored the engineering team on architectural best practices and distributed system design.
- Collaborated within an Agile Scrum team, working with the Scrum Master to estimate effort for new features.

**Payfrontier LTD | Abuja, Nigeria** **Jan 2020 – Jul 2023**
**Senior Developer/CTO (Remote & Onsite)**

- Architected a fintech platform serving 20,000+ active customers across web and mobile channels.
- Designed a microservices ecosystem in Java and PHP spanning web, mobile and administrative systems.
- Directed system wide performance optimisation and horizontal scalability planning across engineering teams.
- Led engineering vision, aligning business growth strategy with technical architecture decisions.

**Thrive Agric LTD | Abuja, Nigeria** **Feb 2018 – Dec 2019**
**Software Developer (Remote & Onsite)**

- Led the migration of the legacy PHP/WordPress platform to Node.js microservices, powering crowdfunding and payment platforms servicing 500,000+ monthly users.
- Built the referral system and single device session security for user accounts.
- Architected backend modules supporting finance, operations, growth, capital allocation and user onboarding.
- Managed, monitored and trained engineers across technology teams.

**UNESCO | Abuja, Nigeria** **May 2016 – Jan 2018**
**Software Engineer & Program Manager (Onsite)**

- Delivered structured software architecture training to 400+ youths in partnership with Microsoft and UNESCO.
- Designed curriculum integrating scalable backend design principles and coordinated the program's rollout across institutions.

**Freelance** **Nov 2014 – Apr 2016**
**Web Developer (Remote)**

- Built custom PHP and MySQL web applications for business clients based on their specifications.
- Built and maintained a portfolio of applications consolidating data from multiple services.
- Managed all aspects of delivery, including design, testing, debugging and deployment.

## EDUCATION

**Ecotes University, De La Grace, Benin | Benin** **2013 – 2017**
Bachelor's degree, Computer Science

## CERTIFICATIONS

**Cisco** **2016**
CCNA, Cisco Networking
**NIIT (Bics LTD) | Abuja, Nigeria** **2015**
Professional Diploma, Network Engineering: database administration, logic building, problem solving, C++ object oriented programming, CCNA, MIS, MCSE, Linux server administration and network security
**EC-Council** **2013**
Certified Ethical Hacker, Systems and Security

## SKILLS & OTHER

**Languages:** Kotlin, PHP, Java, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Rust
**Kotlin/JVM:** Spring Boot, Ktor, Coroutines, Exposed, JUnit, MockK, Gradle (Kotlin DSL), Maven
**PHP:** PHP 8, Laravel, Eloquent, Composer, PHPUnit
**Other Frameworks:** Express.js, Django
**System Design:** Distributed microservices architecture, domain driven boundary definition, payment and settlement flows
**Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis
**Messaging & APIs:** Kafka, REST, GraphQL
**Cloud Services:** AWS, GCP, DigitalOcean, Azure
**DevOps/Tools:** Docker, Kubernetes, Git, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Travis CI), CloudWatch, Terraform, Ansible, Helm
**AI Tools:** Cursor, Claude Code, Codex, Gemini
**Methodologies:** SCRUM, Agile, SDLC, TDD
**Documentation:** API Documentation, Technical Writing, Markdown, Confluence
**Spoken languages:** English, fluent (C2)